THE METHODIST CHURCH GHANA, WINNEBA CIRCUIT

EBENEZER METHODIST CATHEDRAL, WINNEBA

PROGRAMME SCHEDULE

FOR BURIAL AND THANKSGIVING SERVICES

OFFICIATING MINISTERS:

Rt. Rev. John Prince Sackey (Bishop, Winneba Diocese)
V. Rev. Nicholas Odum-Baidoo (Superintendent Minister)
V. Rev. Dr Isaac Nana Abekah (Director, Methodist Rafiki)
Rev'd. Ernest Nana Acheampong (Ebenezer Cathedral)
Rev. Dr Joseph Nana Annan (Ebenezer Cathedral)
Rev. Joseph Mensah-Onumah (Charles Awotwi Pratt Society)
Rt. Rev. Samuel Aidoo-Bervell (Supernumerary)
V. Rev. Dr David Bright Ghartey-Tagoe (Supernumerary)
V. Rev. Emma Ellen Kwofie (Supernumerary)
V. Rev. Victoria Kittoe (Supernumerary)
V. Rev. John A. S. Abraham (Supernumerary)
V. Rev. Eldad Bonney (Supernumerary)
Sis. Joana Danful (Ministerial Student)
Other Ministers Present

IN ATTENDANCE

Bro. Seth Oduro Arthur (Lay Chairman, Winneba Diocese)
Bro. Emmanuel Ebo Mensah (Society Steward)
Sis. Claudia Quayson (Society Steward)
Bro. Frederick Papa Andoh Amissah (Choirmaster)
Bro. Eugene Moses (Singing Band Master)

PART 1:
BURIAL & COMMENDATION SERVICE

Procession
Sentences
Welcome
Opening Hymn - MHB 50/CAN 14
Prayer
Hymn - MHB 110/CAN 29

Biography and Tributes

Offertory
Hymn - MHB 427/CAN 139
Scripture Readings: Psalm 90:1-12; John 14:1-6, 27
Hymn - MHB 432/CAN 141
Sermon
Affirmation of Faith
Christian Charity
Hymn - MHB 679/CAN 227
Service of Thanksgiving
and Commendation
The Lord's Prayer
Announcements
Benediction
Recession - MHB 830

PART 2:
AT THE GRAVE SIDE

Hymn - MHB 615/CAN 203
Committal
Prayer
Vote of Thanks - Family Member
Hymn - CAN 324
Benediction

Biography

OF THE LATE

OBAAHENBAA EKUA KOKOBOH III

A.K.A. AGARTHA BORTSIE / EKUA DUKU

"In the same way, let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in Heaven." ***Matthew 5:16***

With gratitude to God and deep love in our hearts, we celebrate the life of our beloved mother, Obaahenbaa Ekua Kokoboh III, affectionately known as Agartha Botsie and lovingly called Ekua Duku.

She was born on 6th November 1954 to Nana Okyeadze Dontoh of the Nsona Ebusua at Agona Manso, known in private life as Mr. Samuel Kwesi Koomson who worked as a Senior Official at the Town Council in Axim where he retired and Obaapayin Ekua Sam of Simpa Ekumfi Otuam Nsona Ebusua. Born into a noble and respected family, Ekua Duku was the youngest of eleven children, a position that shaped her into a strong, respectful, and compassionate woman who valued family deeply.

She began her early education at the Winneba Anglican School, where she obtained her Middle School Leaving Certificate. Determined to equip herself with practical skills, she learned hairdressing from her senior sister, Mikado. She migrated to Accra to live with her senior brother Opayin Kojo Paintsil. Her desire for growth made her persue further studies at Edern school in Odorkor. Her time in Accra broadened her knowledge and prepared her for greater responsibilities in life.

After her studies, she returned to Winneba to pursue her lifelong dream of becoming a businesswoman. Through hard work, perseverance, and determination, she established herself and became a respected figure in her community.

Agartha was deeply committed to community service. She was an active member of the Fancy Dress Confederation, contributing to cultural and social activities that brought people together. Her passion for leadership and service led her to serve as the first female Assembly Member during the period when Effutu, Ewutu, and Senya were one district. In this role, she demonstrated remarkable dedication, always advocating for the welfare of her people.

She was known as a great mediator, often called upon to settle disputes with wisdom and fairness. A confident and eloquent speaker, she led many marriage ceremonies and family gatherings, offering guidance rooted in tradition and love. Her kindness, generosity, and calm nature made her a pillar in her community. She always stood ready to serve, uplift, and support those around her.

Above all, she was a devoted mother. She married and was blessed with three children, whom she nurtured with love, discipline, and strong values. Her home was a place of warmth, advice, and unwavering support.

Obaahenbaa Ekua Kokoboh III lived a life of service, dignity, and compassion. Her legacy of leadership, kindness, and dedication to family and community will forever remain in our hearts.

May her gentle soul rest in perfect peace.

TRIBUTE

FROM SIBLINGS

"I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith." **2 Timothy 4:7**

Today, we gather not just in sorrow but in deep reflection and gratitude for a life that touched us all so profoundly. We pay tribute to our beloved sister, Ekua Kokoboh III, known to many as Agartha Koomson, and affectionately called Ekua Duku, a name that carried warmth, strength, and a quiet grace that defined her very being.

Ekua Duku was the last of eleven children, a position that often carries both tenderness and resilience. She embodied both. As the youngest, she brought a special light into the family, a light that never dimmed, even in the face of life's challenges. She was cherished, protected, and deeply loved, yet she grew into someone who gave that same love back in abundance.

She was serviceable in every sense of the word, always willing, always ready, always present. If there was a need, Ekua Duku did not wait to be called; she stepped forward with open hands and a willing heart. Her kindness was not loud or boastful, but steady and sincere. She helped not for recognition, but because it was simply who she was.

To her brothers and sisters, she was more than family. She was a companion, a comforter, and a quiet pillar of strength. She listened when others spoke, she gave it when others lacked, and she stood firm when others wavered. Her presence made burdens lighter and joys fuller.

There is a deep ache in losing someone like Ekua Duku because her love was so real, so constant, and so selfless. The silence she leaves behind speaks volumes, reminding us of the laughter, the care, and the countless small acts of love she gave so freely.

Yet even in our grief, we hold onto the truth of that memory verse; she fought her fight, she finished her course, and she kept her faith. Her journey here may have ended, but her impact will echo through every life she touched.

As brothers and sisters, we may feel the weight of her absence, but we also carry the gift of her example. Let us honour her not only in words, but in how we live, by loving more deeply, helping more willingly, and standing for one another just as she did.

Ekua Duku, you were a blessing beyond measure.
You were love in action.
You were family in its truest form.
And though we say goodbye with tears, we hold you forever in our hearts.
Rest well, dear sister. You have done your part.

TRIBUTE

FROM THE CHILDREN

Mena Aga, It is still so hard to believe that you are no longer with us physically. Our hearts ache each day, yet we are comforted by the beautiful memories you left behind. You were not just our mother, you were our strength, our teacher, our protector, and our greatest blessing.

Obaahenbaa Ekua Kokoboh III, our beloved Ekua Duku, you carried your title with dignity and grace, but to us, you were simply "Aga" warm, loving, firm, and wise. You taught us the meaning of respect, humility, and hard work. Through your words and your actions, you showed us how to stand tall, speak boldly, and treat others with kindness.

You were our safe place. In moments of fear and uncertainty, you reassured us. In times when we doubted ourselves, you reminded us who we were. You sacrificed so much to ensure we had the best you could give. Your strength as a mother shaped our lives in ways words can never fully express.

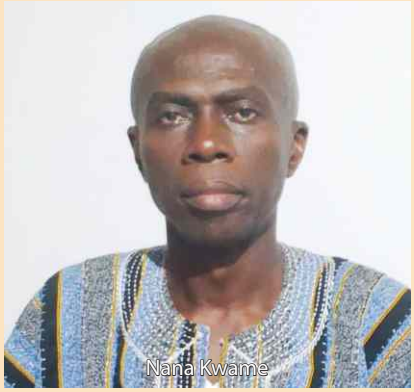
We remember your voice how you spoke with confidence and wisdom. We remember how you led, how you advised, how you settled disputes and brought peace. You were a woman of courage and compassion, and we were always so proud to call you our mother.
Aga, Naab says who will prepare his Etsew and fante fante for him.

Your love was unconditional. Even when you corrected us, it was done with love. Even when life was not easy, you never gave up on us. You prayed for us, guided us, and stood by us. That love will remain with us forever.

Though tears fill our eyes, gratitude fills our hearts. Thank you for the values you instilled in us. Thank you for your sacrifices. Thank you for your laughter, your strength, and your endless care.

We promise to honor your legacy. We will carry your name with pride. We will live by the principles you taught us. And we will keep your memory alive in our hearts and in the generations to come.

Rest peacefully, Aga.


Nana Kwame

Endurance

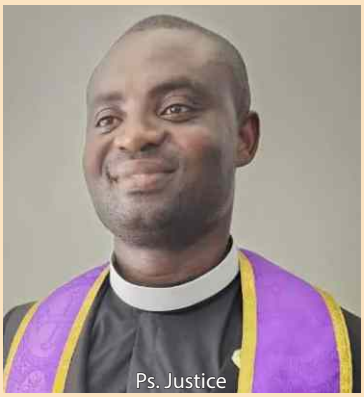
Anita

Charles

Patrick

Nana Yaw

Neenyi


Ps. Justice

Patience

Ps. Stephen

Mercy

Ophelia

Francisca

Tribute

FROM THE GRANDCHILDREN

Grandma, where do we even begin… this still feels so surreal. We never imagined we would be here, trying to honour someone who meant so much to us.

You were our light, our angel, and the heart of our family. You loved us deeply, supported us in everything, and always made us feel special. You were our biggest cheerleader, always encouraging us to be strong, confident, and fearless.

We will always cherish the Sundays you brought us together, especially over fufu and soup. Those moments of laughter and togetherness meant everything to us.

Grandma Aga,please, who will take us to watch the Fancy Dress every 1st January?.

It hurts so much that you are no longer here, but we take comfort in knowing you are resting in the bosom of the Lord. We pray for the strength to carry on and to continue making you proud.

We love you so much, Grandma, and we will carry you in our hearts forever.

A PERSONAL
Tribute to Grandma

Grandma… you were my rock, my angel, my everything. You were my biggest supporter and my greatest cheerleader. Even when you didn't fully understand what I was doing, especially with university, you always believed in me and reminded me that I was strong and capable.

You loved me so deeply, and I felt it in everything you did. From the way you pampered me to the way you constantly uplifted me, you made me feel so special. I will always hold onto the name you gave me, "Me Maame ,"and the love behind it.

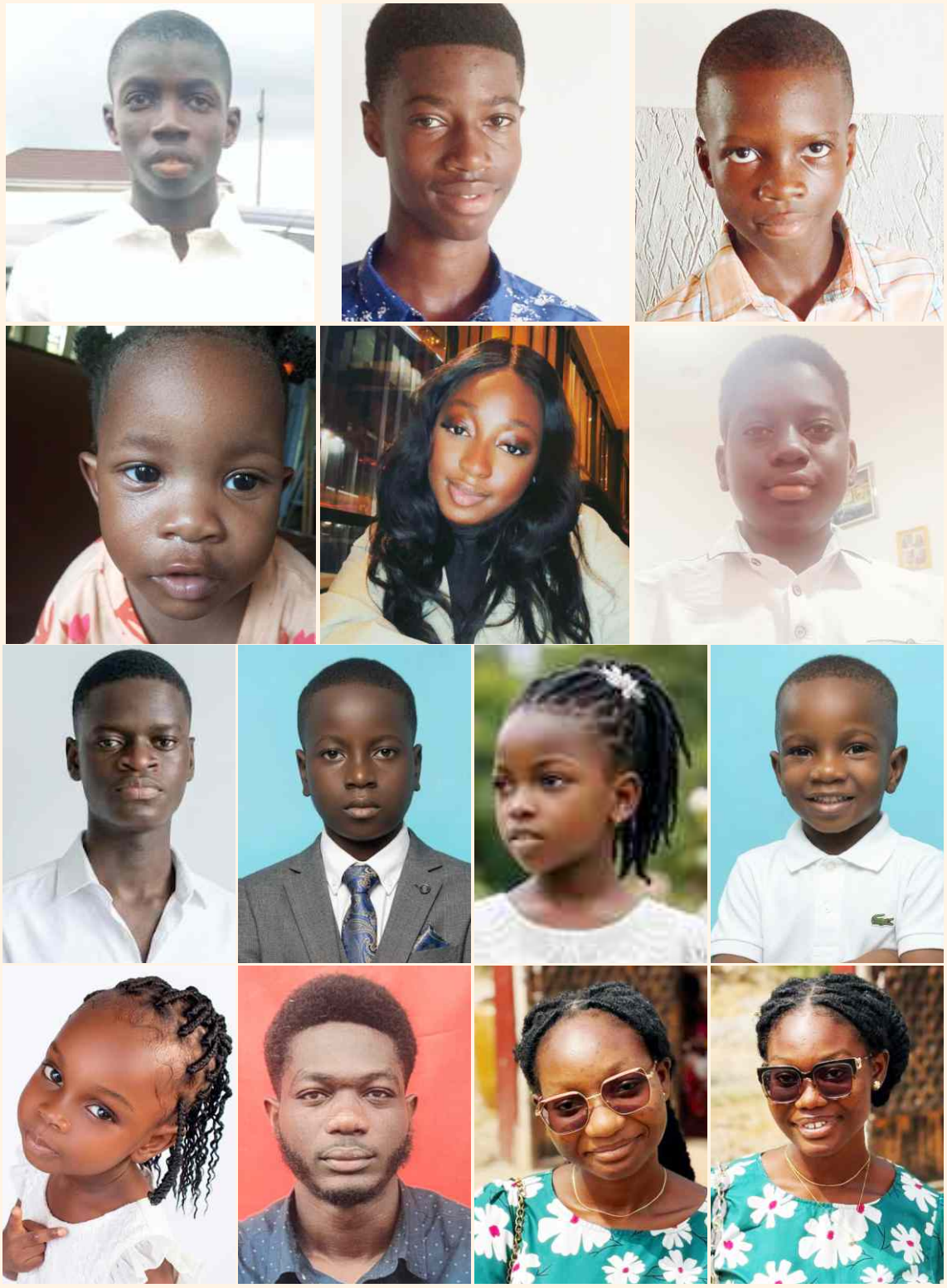
I'll never forget how you always made sure I looked my best, always reminding me to adorn myself in your jewelry. You were truly a fashionista, and those little moments mean so much to me now.

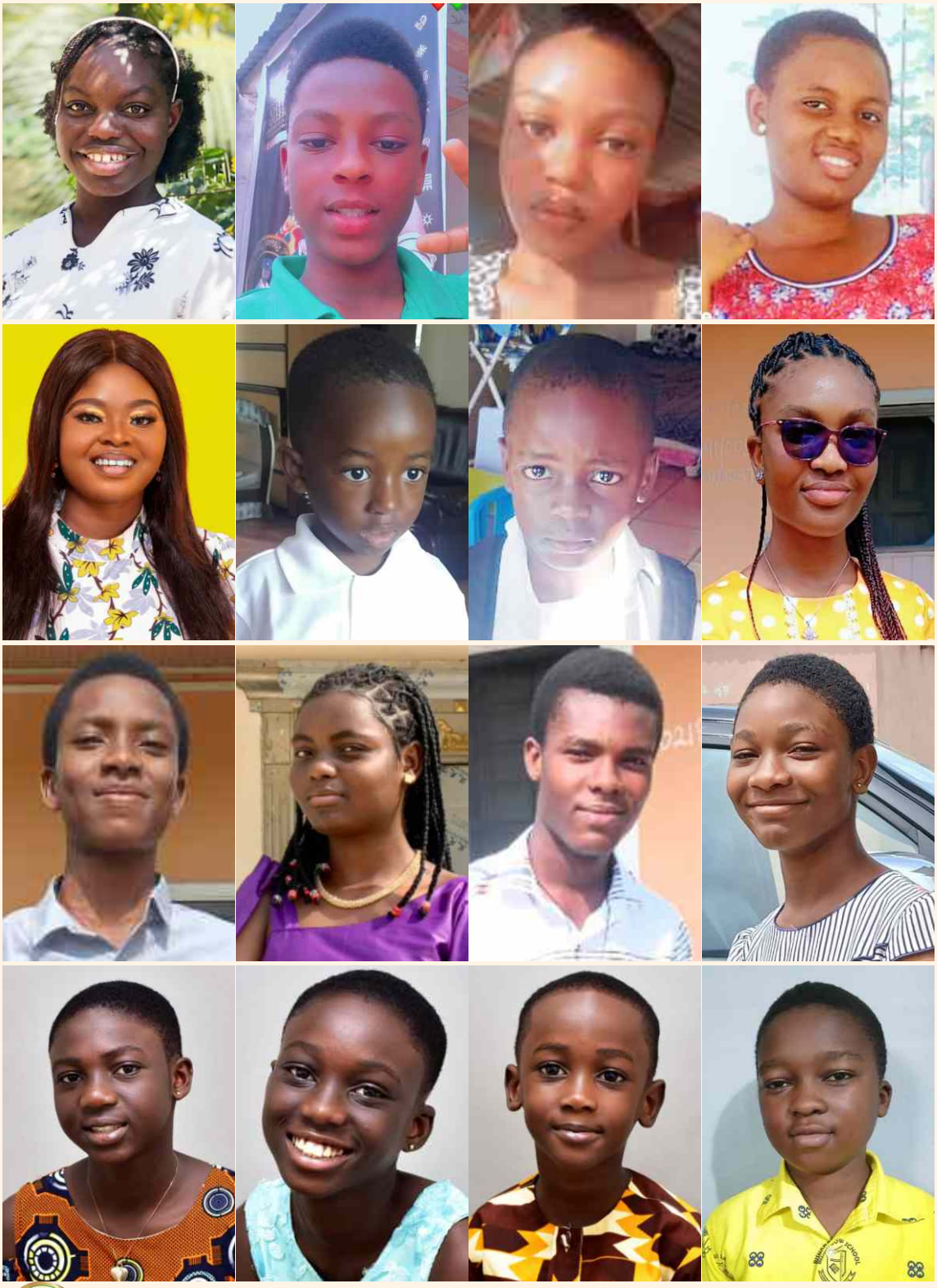
I remember how excited we both were when you asked me about my graduation, and I told you it would be later this year. It breaks my heart that you won't be here to see it, but I know you'll be cheering me on from heaven. I know you are, and always will be, so proud of me.

Thank you for bringing me closer to God and for teaching me to be strong, confident, and fearless. You showed me how to stand up for myself, no matter what.

I love you so much, Grandma. Life will never be the same without you, but I promise to make you proud.

Rest well, my angel





TRIBUTE

FROM THE COUSINS

Jesus said to her, "I am the resurrection and the life. The one who believes in me will live, even though they die; [26] and whoever lives by believing in me will never die. Do you believe this? **John 11:25-26**

What we feel within us now is a deep silence, a quiet sadness, a longing for just one more day, one more word, one more touch, one more smile. We may never fully understand why you left this world so soon or why you left before we were ready to say goodbye. But as the days go by, we are learning to accept not just your passing from this mortal world but to cherish the beautiful truth that you lived, and that your life gave us memories too precious to ever forget.

It was with profound sorrow that we received the painful and unexpected news of the passing of our dear cousin and sister Agartha. Sister Aga, you were the very definition of beauty in all you did. You had a big heart and your countless acts of love touched so many lives. We admired your kindness, generosity, thoughtfulness and the genuine care you showed to everyone. To us, you were simply the best and your life was a priceless gift.

So many beautiful memories of you continue to play in our minds. We especially remember your time as an Assemblywoman when you made sure to provide meals for everyone who came to support community clean up exercises. You also served diligently as a caterer for the Winneba Advance Stars Football Team and truly no one ever visited your home without leaving with a stomach full. All this without ever attending a catering school. Your love was expressed in action and it never went unnoticed.

Words cannot fully capture our lose but we hold on to this truth: When someone you love becomes a memory, that memory becomes a treasure.

Till we meet again Sister Aga. May your beautiful soul rest in perfect peace. Fare thee well.

TRIBUTE

FROM IN-LAWS

Today, with hearts wrapped in love and remembrance, we pay tribute to Obaahenbaa Ekua Kokoboh III, our beloved Maame Aga.

Maame Aga, you were strength clothed in grace, wisdom wrapped in gentleness, and authority carried with deep compassion. To many, you were a queen mother and a pillar of tradition. To us, you were family, present, prayerful, protective, and profoundly loving.

From your in-laws, Patience Mildred Ababio, whom you so affectionately called Pat and Mr. Emmanuel Aigboje Imoukhuede ,your dear Oneil,this tribute comes with gratitude and deep affection.

Maame Aga, I remember how you would always say to me, "Take good care of Naab and the grandchildren." Your voice carried both instruction and blessing. You were especially mindful of Neenyi and little Ababio, often asking about them with a grandmother's tender concern. You entrusted them to me not just as a duty, but as a sacred responsibility of love.

In those simple yet powerful words, you showed how deeply family mattered to you. Your charge to me remains a living promise to nurture, to guide, and to protect the generations you cherished so dearly.

To Oneil, you extended the same loving expectation. You would remind him to take care of Obomba, and to look after your granddaughter "sister Anthonia" and Omobai. Your requests were never burdens; they were expressions of trust. You believed in us enough to place your loved ones in our hands.

Maame Aga, you lived as a matriarch in the truest sense, not only guiding a community but holding your family close, ensuring that love flowed from one generation to the next. Your life was a testament to unity, responsibility, and enduring affection.

Though we miss your presence deeply, we carry your words with us.

Rest peacefully, Maame Aga.

TRIBUTE

FROM VICTORY BIBLE CHURCH INTERNATIONAL, GRACE SANCTUARY, WINNEBA

"Show me, Lord, my life's end and the number of my days; let me know how fleeting my life is" **Psalm 39:4**

The history of Victory Bible Church International, Grace Sanctuary – Winneba cannot be written without mentioning the pivotal role Obaahenbaa Ekua Kokoboh III affectionately called Aunty Agartha played in its establishment. She was a pioneering member of the church.

She was also an instrumentalist, playing drums. A duty she performed with passion. A number of the women in the church looked up to her as a role model. She exhibited servanthood qualities: always ready to serve and help others.

Even though she left Victory Bible Church International to join the Methodist Church, she maintained a very cordial relationship with the church. Together with her late husband, Osagyefo Nana Kojo Beedu V, they supported and honoured our invitation to fellowship with us on every opportune occasion.

Auntie Agartha, it is our prayer that the good Lord will grant you peaceful rest in paradise. Until we meet again on the resurrection, rest well in the bosom of Abraham.

Photo GALLERY

2017 12 25 16 10

PEPSI

METHODIST CHURCH GHANA
CHRIST'S LITTLE BAND
1986
ESTABLISHED 1886

Making disciples of all nations
YTS

Hymns

HYMN 50

1. The Lord's my shepherd, I'll not want.
He makes me down to lie
In pastures green: he leadeth me
the quiet waters by.

2. My soul he doth restore again;
and me to walk doth make
Within the paths of righteousness,
ev'n for his own name's sake.

3. Yea, though I walk in death's dark vale,
yet will I fear none ill:
For thou art with me; and thy rod
and staff me comfort still.

4. My table thou hast furnishèd
In presence of my foes;
My head thou dost with oil anoint,
And my cup overflows.

5. Goodness and mercy all my life
Shall surely follow me,
And in God's house forever more
My dwelling place shall be.

HYMN 110

1. Jesus, lover of my soul,
let me to thy bosom fly,
while the nearer waters roll,
while the tempest still is high;
hide me, O my Savior, hide,
till the storm of life is past;
safe into the haven guide,
O receive my soul at last!

2. Other refuge have I none;
hangs my helpless soul on thee;
leave, ah! leave me not alone,
still support and comfort me.
All my trust on thee is stayed,
all my help from thee I bring;
cover my defenseless head
with the shadow of thy wing.

3. Plenteous grace with thee is found,
grace to cover all my sin;
let the healing streams abound;
make and keep me pure within.
Thou of life the fountain art;
freely let me take of thee;
spring thou up within my heart,
rise to all eternity.

HMN 427

1. Through all the changing scenes of life,
in trouble and in joy,
the praises of my God shall still
my heart and tongue employ.
Of his deliv'rance I will boast,
till all that are distressed,
from my example comfort take
and lay their griefs to rest.

2. O magnify the LORD with me,
exalt his holy name;
when in distress to him I called,
he to my rescue came.
The hosts of God encamp around
the dwellings of the just;
deliv'rance he affords to all
who in his promise trust.

3. O taste and see that he is good;
experience will decide
how blest are they, and only they
who in the LORD confide.
Fear him, you saints, and you will then
have nothing else to fear;
make serving him your sole delight,
your wants shall be his care.

HYMN 432

1. Hark, my soul, it is the Lord;
'tis thy Saviour, hear his word;
Jesus speaks, and speaks to thee,
'Say, poor sinner, lov'st thou me?

2. 'I delivered thee when bound,
and, when wounded, healed thy wound;
sought thee wandering, set thee right,
turned thy darkness into light.

3. 'Can a woman's tender care
cease towards the child she bare?
Yes, she may forgetful be,
yet will I remember thee.
4. 'Mine is an unchanging love,
higher than the heights above,
deeper than the depths beneath,
free and faithful, strong as death.

5. 'Thou shalt see my glory soon,
when the work of grace is done;
partner of my throne shalt be:
say, poor sinner, lov'st thou me?'

6. Lord, it is my chief complaint
that my love is weak and faint;
yet I love thee, and adore;
O for grace to love thee more!

HYMN 679
1. Pleasant are Thy courts above
In the land of light and love;
Pleasant are Thy courts below
In this land of sin and woe.
O my spirit longs and faints
For the converse of Thy saints,
For the brightness of Thy face,
For Thy fullness, God of grace.

2. Happy birds that sing and fly
Round Thy altars, O Most High;
Happier souls that find a rest
In a heavenly Father's breast!
Like the wandering dove that found
No repose on earth around,
They can to their ark repair
And enjoy it ever there.

3. Happy souls, their praises flow
Even in this vale of woe;
Waters in the desert rise,
Manna feeds them from the skies;
On they go from strength to strength
Till they reach Thy throne at length,
At Thy feet adoring fall,
Who hast led them safe through all.

4. Lord, be mine this prize to win;
Guide me through a world of sin,
Keep me by Thy saving grace,
Give me at Thy side a place.
Sun and shield alike Thou art;
Guide and guard my erring heart.
Grace and glory flow from Thee;
Shower, O shower them, Lord, on me.

HYMN 830
1. Hark! The sound of holy voices,
chanting at the crystal sea:
alleluia, alleluia,
alleluia, Lord, to thee:
multitude, which none can number,
like the stars in glory stands,
clothed in white apparel, holding
palms of victory in their hands.

2. Patriarch and holy prophet,
who prepared the way of Christ,
king, apostle, saint, confessor,
martyr and evangelist,
saintly maiden, godly matron,
widows who have watched to prayer,
joined in holy concert, singing
to the Lord of all, are there.

3. They have come from tribulation,
and have washed their robes in blood,
washed them in the blood of Jesus;
tried they were, and firm they stood;
gladly, Lord, with thee they suffered;
gladly, Lord, with thee they died,
and by death to life immortal
they were born, and glorified.

4. Now they reign in heavenly glory,
now they walk in golden light,
now they drink, as from a river,
holy bliss and infinite;
love and peace they taste for ever,
and all truth and knowledge see
in the beatific vision
of the blessèd Trinity.

5. God of God, the One-begotten,
Light of Light, Emmanuel,
in whose Body joined together
all the saints for ever dwell;
pour upon us of thy fullness,
that we may for evermore
God the Father, God the Son, and
God the Holy Ghost adore.

HYMN 615
1. Guide me, O my great Redeemer,
pilgrim through this barren land;
I am weak, but you are mighty;
hold me with your powerful hand.
Bread of heaven, bread of heaven,
feed me now and evermore,
feed me now and evermore.

2. Open now the crystal fountain,
where the healing waters flow.
Let the fire and cloudy pillar
lead me all my journey through.
Strong Deliverer, strong Deliverer,
ever be my strength and shield,
ever be my strength and shield.

3. When I tread the verge of Jordan,
bid my anxious fears subside.
Death of death, and hell's Destruction,
land me safe on Canaan's side.
Songs of praises, songs of praises
I will ever sing to you,
I will ever sing to you.

HYMN 324
324 The wanderer returning to Christ.
1. Jesus thou know'st my sinfulness
My faults are not concealed from thee;
A sinner in my last distress,
To thy dear wounds I fain would flee,
And never, never thence depart,
Close sheltered in thy loving heart.

2. How shall I find the living way, Lost,
and confused, and dark, and blind?
Ah! Lord, my soul is gone astray;
Ah! Shepherd, seek my soul, and find,
And in thine arms of mercy take,
And bring the weary wanderer back.

3. Weary and sick of sin I am; I hate it,
Lord, and yet I love; When wilt thou rid
me of my shame? When wilt thou all
my load remove? Destroy the fiend that lurks within. And speak the word of power, "Be clean!"

4. Sin only let me not commit,
Sin never can advance thy praise;
And, lo! I lay me at thy feet, And wait unwearied all my days, Till my appointed time shall come,
And thou shalt call thine exile home.

Appreciation

We wish to express our sincere gratitude
to all who since the bereavement
have shown concern with prayer
and other expression of
condolences.

Thank you, God bless you all.

ROYAL TRANSITION

of the late

OBAAHENBAA EKUA KOKOBOH III

(AGARTHA BORTSIE)

1954 - 2026